

Rise of the Forgemasters

A fan made expansion for Mage Knight

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Expansion Overview

This expansion contains 3 modules:

In **New Beginning**, you can find most of the original Advanced Action cards (some of them rebalanced and tweaked) as well as a few new simple cards and some new terminology.

The **Spoils of War** module introduces Mana Shards into the game, and some new game concepts like delayed effects and the ability to play an effect with a bonus or penalty. It also includes some changes to the Basic Action cards.

Elixir of Life includes more complex rules and is intended for experienced players. It adds Potions, new abilities, new attack types, and a brand new character.

New Beginning

The first module of the Rise of the Forgemasters expansion adds several new cards, and modifies some of the existing cards. The more complex cards were removed from this module, but appear in the second and third modules.

There aren't any new or changed rules required in order to use this module. All future content that can be added to the game without adding more rules will be added to this module.

Spoils of War

This module adds many more cards into the game, and introduces some new rules and tokens. This module is recommended for players who feel adventurous and wish to spice up their game with a few new game concepts.

Updated Basic Actions

Some Basic Action cards have been updated in the game. For example, you can now play Concentration to play the basic effect of another Action card with a bonus of +2.

Detailed Game Concepts

Immediate Effects

An **immediate** effect is an effect that resolves when it is played (most effects are immediate). Some immediate effects allow you to immediately play other effects. An immediate effect that just provides Move, Influence or any types of Block or Attack, is called a **modifiable** effect. In many cases, an effect is composed of multiple effects - some that are modifiable and some that are not. In particular - gaining Heal, Fame, Reputation, or modifying armor or attack of a target are not modifiable effects. Some immediate effects can be repeated a limited or unlimited number of times as part of resolving those effects.

Delayed Effects

An effect that is not immediate is called a **delayed** effect. There are two types of delayed effects: **triggered** effects and **lasting** effects. A triggered effect is an effect that automatically resolves when a certain event occurs or a set of conditions is met. A lasting effect is an effect that can be resolved by the player's choice at any time unless specified otherwise. A delayed effect details if it is resolved a limited or unlimited number of times. Unless specified otherwise, a delayed effect ends at the end of the turn it was played.

Examples

- You play the Advanced Action card **Path Finding** to gain Move 2 and reduce the Move cost of all terrains by 1, to a minimum of 2 this turn. That card provides you with two immediate effects. Only the Move 2 is a modifiable effect.
- You play the Spell card **Burning Shield** for Fire Block 4 during the block step of combat (this is an immediate effect). You successfully block an enemy's attack using that block and so you will gain Fire Attack 4 during the Attack phase of combat (this is a triggered delayed effect).

- You play the basic effect of the Advanced Action **Learning** and gain Influence 2 as an immediate effect. You also gain a delayed lasting effect (which can be resolved once at any time during your turn) that allows you to gain an Advanced Action from the Advanced Actions offer to your discard pile.

Playing an effect with a bonus

When an **immediate** effect is played with a bonus, that bonus's modifier applies to the first **modifiable** effect it provides. Delayed effects are not affected by bonuses. A bonus might be limited to only Move, Influence, Block or Attack - in that case the bonus applies only if the effect would provide the mentioned effect.

Playing an effect with a penalty

When an **immediate** effect is played with a penalty, that penalty's modifier applies to the first **modifiable** effect it provides. Apply as much of that penalty's modifier as possible (modifiable effects cannot have a negative value), and apply the rest to the next modifiable effect that is provided by effect with that penalty. When an effect resolves without applying some of its penalty's modifier, the player who has played it gains Wounds to their hand according to the penalty modifier that was not applied. Delayed effects are not affected by bonuses.

Playing an effect with both bonuses and penalties

If a modifiable effect is affected by both bonuses and penalties, apply all bonuses first and then apply as many penalties as possible (starting from the most recent penalty).

Examples

- You play the stronger effect of the Basic Action card **Concentration** to play the stronger effect of the Advanced Action card **Diligence**, and with it you play the Basic Action card **Rage**. The bonuses of +2 from **Concentration** and +3 from **Diligence** are applied to the Attack gained by **Rage**, so you get Attack 9 (4+3+2).

- You play the stronger effect of **Concentration** to play the stronger effect of the Advanced Action card **Dodge and Weave**. Neither of the effects benefit from the bonus, because the reduction to the enemy's attack is not a modifiable effect, and the Attack 2 part is a delayed effect.

- Suppose you have a way to play the stronger effect of the Basic Action card **Swiftness** with a penalty of -1. Instead of Ranged Attack 3, you would gain only Ranged Attack 2.

- Suppose you have a way to play the stronger effect of the Basic Action card **Tranquility** with a penalty of -1. You will either draw two cards or gain Heal 2, and then when the effect of **Tranquility** resolves you will gain a Wound, because the penalty can only be applied to modifiable effects.

- Suppose you have a way to play the stronger effect of the Basic Action card **Concentration** with a penalty of -1, and with it you play the Basic Action card **Rage**. You first apply all bonuses to the first modifiable effect (Attack 4 + 2), and then you apply as many penalties as you can (Attack 4 + 2 - 1 = Attack 5).

Color Scarcity

Some new effects require you to determine which colors are scarce, or whether a specific color is scarce. A Scarce color is one of the least common **basic** colors among all mana dice. This **includes dice that are taken or being used**, but excludes stolen dice.

Example

- There are 3 mana dice in the game - two red dice in the Source, and a blue mana die that you currently use on the Basic Action card **Determination**. In this case, the basic colors green and white both appear 0 times among all dice, so they are considered the scarce colors in this situation.

- You picked the Day Tactics card **Mana Steal** and stole a blue mana die. There are three white mana dice in the Source, so all basic colors except white (blue, green, red) are considered scarce colors now. When you take the blue die from **Mana Steal** and use it, then only green and red are scarce.

- There are four dice in the Source - red white, green and blue. In this case, all basic colors are tied for the least common basic color, so all basic colors are considered scarce.

Tuck a card

When a player is instructed to tuck cards (usually unplayed cards from their hand), they reveal those cards and place them on the bottom of their Deed deck in any order. Players cannot tuck Wound cards, and are unable to tuck any cards while their Deed deck is empty. When a player tucks multiple cards at the same time, they are not required to reveal the order of these cards to the other players.

Prepare a card

When a player is instructed to prepare cards, they place those cards on top of their Deed deck. Players are allowed to prepare cards even if their Deed deck is empty, and they are even allowed to prepare Wound cards. Whenever a player prepares cards, they are not required to reveal those cards or their order.

Mana shards

A **mana shard** is an incomplete mana crystal. It counts as a crystal of that color for all intents and purposes, except it has a penalty of -1 when being used or paid and it does not count as a crystal for final scoring. If the shard is not used or paid, but is being converted into anything else, you gain a Wound.

In your inventory, you are limited to one shard of each color, and a total of three crystals of each color (one of them can be a shard). You are allowed to move unused shards between your play area and your inventory.

During the **Clear up your Play Area** step of your **End of Turn** phase, gain a Wound for each excess unused shards you have and discard them. If you get a crystal after that step, you may either forfeit it, or move your shard to the play area and make room for the new crystal.

During **Interaction** in a **Mage Tower**, you can buy any number of mana shards, each for a mana of that color and 1 Influence.

Examples

- You use a green shard on the Basic Action card **Concentration** to play the Basic Action card **Swiftness** for Ranged Attack 4.
- You use a white shard on **Dodge and Weave** in the block phase to reduce an enemy's attack by 4, and then you receive a Wound (because the effect resolved without applying the shard's penalty). In the Attack phase you do not gain Attack 2, because you gained a Wound in a previous phase.
- You pay two blue shards along with a blue mana token in an Altar (3 blue mana), so you gain 2 Wound cards and 7 Fame.
- You use a red shard to play the Spell card **Fire Shield**. You get Fire Block 3 as an immediate effect, and if you successfully block with it then you gain Fire Attack 4 (delayed effect).
- You have a white crystal and a red mana shard in your Inventory. You play the Advanced Action card **Crystal Mastery** and gain a red crystal (shards are still crystals).

Elixir of Life

This module builds upon the previous modules and adds more complex game concepts and a brand new character. This module is intended for players who are already experienced with the previous modules, and dare to venture into more intricate content.

Innate Fortification

When an enemy or Unit has **Innate Fortification**, thematically it means that using thier quick reflexes and armor proficiency, they can easily block projectile attacks. When an enemy has the Fortified ability printed on them (not gained from site fortification), it means they have Innate Fortification.

A Unit with Innate Fortification has all its blocks count twice against an attack with Swiftness (Utem Guardsmen and Altem Guardians already have Innate Fortification).

An enemy with Unfortified cannot benefit from Innate Fortification and is never considered Fortified. When an enemy's Innate Fortification is removed, it does not affect their Site Fortification and vice versa.

Arcane Immunity

A Unit with **Arcane Immunity** is immune to any additional effects of Wounds, such as Poison, Paralyze and Vampiric. In PvP, the Unit is immune to all special effects played by your opponents.

Arcane Vulnerability

An enemy with **Arcane Vulnerability** can be affected by any special effects regardless of other resistances. A Unit with Arcane Vulnerability is affected by the additional effects of Wounds, such as Poison, Paralyze, Vampiric, regardless of whether the Unit was wounded or not after assigning damage to them. In PvP, the Unit can be the target of any special effects regardless of their other resistances. Opponents and bosses (like Volkare and faction leaders) can never be affected by Arcane Vulnerability.

A Unit or enemy that gains Arcane Immunity immediately loses their Arcane Vulnerability, and vice versa (Arcane Immunity does not protect against Arcane Vulnerability).

Potions

A **potion** is a new type of token, with multiple purposes, that can be gained during the game. There are four colors of potions: white, green, blue and red. Each potion token has two sides - full side and spent side. Gaining a new potion or refilling one of your potions (flipping it to the full side) are always considered healing effects (cannot be done during combat).

When you gain a potion, take the corresponding token from the supply and place it in your Inventory. You can have only one potion of each color in your Inventory. If you gain a potion that you already have in your inventory, you simply refill it.

At the end of the game, each potion is worth 1 point for the **Greatest Loot** title.

During Interaction in a **Mage Tower**, **Monastery** or **City**, you may buy any number of potions of non-scarce colors for 2 Influence each. You may also buy one potion of a scarce color for 3 Influence.

You may also buy potions in the **Village**, each costs 1 more Influence than usual.

During the game, there are four different uses for potions:

Apply some potion to a crystal being used

Whenever you use (or pay) a crystal of any color, if you have a full potion of that color in your Inventory, you may **spend** it (flip it to spent side) to add a bonus of +1 to the effect that will be provided by the crystal. You have to do so at the exact time that you use (or pay) the crystal, and not after the effect has already resolved.

Apply some potion to a mana shard being used

Whenever you use (or pay) a mana shard of any color, if you have a full potion of that color in your Inventory, you may **spend** it to prevent the shard's -1 penalty (and the Wound you'd receive from that penalty). You have to do so at the exact time that you use (or pay) the shard, and not after the effect has already resolved. Cannot be used to prevent the Wound from a discarded or converted mana shard.

Let a Unit drink a potion

You can **discard** a potion token to give one of your Units a positive effect that will last until the end of the turn. Mark that Unit with the potion token and discard the token to the supply at the end of the turn. The effect on that Unit depends on the potion's color:

- White: Gains Arcane Immunity
- Green: Gains Innate Fortification
- Blue: Gains Ice Resistance
- Red: Gains Fire Resistance

Throw a potion on an enemy

You can **discard** a potion token to apply a negative effect to an enemy you are facing, that will last until the end of the combat. Mark that enemy with the potion token and discard the token at the end of the combat. The effect on that enemy depends on the potion's color:

- White: Gains Arcane Vulnerability
- Green: Loses Innate Fortification
- Blue: Loses Ice Resistance
- Red: Loses Fire Resistance

Examples

- You have only a spent white potion in your Inventory, and want to buy potions during an Interaction in a Monastery. The scarce colors are red and blue. You can buy potions - 2 for a white potion (simply flip the one you have), 2 for a green potion, and 3 for a blue or red potion (not both).
- You spend a white potion and pay a white crystal to play the Basic Action card **Swiftness**. You gain Ranged Attack 4.
- You spend a green potion and pay a green shard to play the Basic Action card **Tranquility**. You draw two cards and don't get any Wound because you prevented the shard's penalty. Had you drawn the two cards without spending the green potion, you wouldn't have been able to spend it because the effect has already resolved (new information revealed).
- You discard a red potion to remove the Fire Resistance of the **Lava Dragon** you are facing, and then you defeat it using the **Firestorm** spell card (Take a Wound. Siege Fire Attack 8).
- You discard a blue potion to remove the Ice Resistance of the **Ice Dragon** you are facing, and use the spell **Chill** to prevent the dragon's attack.
- You discard a white potion to give the **Dragon Summoner** you are facing Arcane Vulnerability, and defeat it using the spell **Tornado**.

- You discard a green potion to remove the Innate Fortification of the Crypt Worm you are facing, and defeat it using Ranged Attack 6.
- You discard a green potion to give Innate Fortification to your **Guardian Golems** Unit and then you spend a red potion with a red shard to activate the Guardian Golems for Fire Block 4 that counts twice against an attack with Swiftiness. You can use this Block to successfully block a **Storm Dragon**.
- You discard a white potion to give Arcane Immunity to your **Delphana Masters** Unit, and assign the attack of an **Ice Dragon** to them. This will cause them to be Wounded, but not destroyed because the Arcane Immunity protects them against additional effects of the Wound.

Restricted Move Points

Some effects provide a special type of Move Points that cannot be spent to pay terrain costs. Count these Restricted Move Points separately than your normal Move Points, and announce which ones you use when you need to spend Move Points. Restricted Move Points can be used for all other uses of Move Points: exploring, paying to move over walls, entering a maze, reducing an attack of an enemy with Cumbersome, etc.

Poisonous Attacks

Some effects allow players to play Poisonous Attacks, which deal more damage at the cost of defeating their target at a slower pace.

One Poisonous Attack in each attack can be counted an additional time. If the targeted enemies would be defeated, instead their attacks are halved rounded up and they are defeated only at the end of the combat. This means that the player will not receive any bonuses for defeating them in that attack or that attack phase.

Ranged and Siege Attacks phase

You cannot use a Poisonous Attack in the Ranged and Siege Attacks phase of combat, unless it also has a type that allows you to do so (like Ranged). When using the effect of a Poisonous Attack in the Ranged and Siege phase of combat, the targeted enemies have all their attacks halved (rounded up). Summoning Attacks ignore this effect.

Attack phase

When using the effect of a Poisonous Attack in the Attack phase, you will receive 1 less Fame for each enemy defeated by that attack, to a minimum of 1. If the Fame you receive is multiplied (e.g. Druid Nights Scenario), apply this reduction afterwards.

Enemies Immune to Poisonous Attacks

Currently, only enemies with Arcane Immunity are immune to Poisonous Attacks. If you play a Poisonous Attack during an attack targeting at least one enemy with Arcane Immunity, you cannot use the effect of that Attack.

Player vs Player combat

In Player vs Player combat Poisonous Attacks work differently than against normal enemies. When all Attacks played in a single attack are Poisonous Attacks, all damage assigned using this attack has the same effect as the normal Poisonous effect:

- A Unit will be assigned two Wounds instead of one (unless it has Arcane Immunity)
- A player will receive a Wound card to their discard pile for each Wound card received to their hand.

Examples

- You use a Poisonous Ranged Attack 5 in the Ranged and Siege phase combat against a **Werewolf** and a **Minotaur**. Since neither of them has Arcane Immunity, you can count that Attack an additional time. Ranged Attack 10 is enough to defeat them (they have a combined armor of 10), and so they will be defeated only at the end of the combat. The Werewolf will attack with a Swift attack of 4 (instead of 7) and the Minotaur will attack with a Brutal attack of 3 (instead of 5). You get the normal Fame (9).
- You fight two enemies in the same combat: **Swordsmen** and **Guardsmen**. In the Attack phase you play the Ultimate of the Artifact Soul Harvester (Attack 8. Gain one crystal as above for each enemy defeated in the current phase of combat.) and the basic effect of the Advanced Action Pernicious Bolt for Poisonous Attack 2. You use the Poisonous effect to add an additional Attack 2, and then you have a total of Attack 12, which is enough to defeat them both in a single attack. They will both be defeated only at the end of the combat, so you get no crystals from Soul Harvester, and you gain only 5 Fame for defeating them (instead of 7).

Assassinating Attacks

Some effects allow players to play Assassinating Attacks, which are quick sneaky surprise strikes. These attacks are extremely deadly when used in attacks against a single target.

Count each Assassinating Attack an additional time when being used against the higher armor of a **single Elusive enemy**. During each of your attacks in the Ranged and Siege phase, you may use **one** Assassinating Attack if the attack targets only a **single enemy**.

Site Fortification and Innate Fortification

Enemies with Innate Fortification are immune to the effects of Assassinating Attacks. You can use Assassinating Attacks in the Ranged and Siege phase even if the target has Site Fortification (you sneak past it).

Attacking multiple enemies

All bonuses of Assassinating Attacks apply only during attacks targeting a single enemy. If you attack multiple enemies in the same attack, you can treat Assassinating Attacks as if they were simple (melee) Attacks.

Greater than the sum of its parts

The limitation of only one Assassinating Attack in each attack in the Ranged and Siege phase, means that if you have several small Assassinating Attacks then you must use each against a different enemy.

Player vs Player combat

In Player vs Player combat Assassinating Attacks work differently than against normal enemies. You can use one Assassinating Attack during each attack in the Ranged and Siege phase. If you do, then you must assign all the damage from the entire attack to a single target. If the Assassinating Attack was the only Attack you played during that attack, then the damage you assign to the opponent can be spent as if it was assigned in the Attack phase of PvP combat (can push and steal Artifacts). In the (melee) Attack phase, you can play Assassinating Attacks as if they were normal Attacks (you can play multiple during the same attack and assign damage normally).

Examples

- In the Dungeon you play the stronger effect of the Advanced Action **Dark Dealings** for Assassinating Attack 4. This is enough to defeat the **Shadow** in the Ranged and Siege phase, because you count it an additional time (Attack 8) when attacking the higher armor (8) of Shadow.
- When fighting a Storm Dragon, you play the stronger effect of the Basic Action card **Concentration** to play the stronger effect of Advanced Action card **Noxiousness** for Poisonous Assassinating Attack 5 in the Ranged and Siege phase. You count the Attack an additional time because you are attacking the higher armor of the Storm Dragon. You can count it an additional time from the Poisonous, for a total of Attack 15. This is enough to defeat the Storm Dragon, but because you had to use the effect of Poisonous then it will be defeated only at the end of the combat. It will still attack you with an Ice Attack 2 with Swiftess (instead of 4).
- When fighting a **Medusa** and a **Hydra**, you play the stronger effect of Concentration to play the stronger effect of the Advanced Action card **Feinting Flare** in the Ranged and Siege phase. You reduce all attacks of the Hydra by 2 (all become 0), and gain Assassinating Attack 4 against the second enemy (won't work against a single enemy) which is enough to defeat the Medusa. Since the Assassinating Attack from Feinting Flare is gained in the Ranged and Siege phase, you must use it in that phase (otherwise it is lost).
- During the Ranged and Siege phase of Player vs Player combat, you play the stronger effect of the Advanced Action card Cloud of Steel, which gives you Ice Assassinating Attack 2 as an immediate effect. You also play the stronger effect of Ice Bolt in the same attack. So you have a total of Ice Attack 5, and some of it is Assassinating. The opponent decides to use thier Guardian Golems Unit for Fire Block 4, which reduces the Attack to Ice Attack 3. You have to assign this damage to a single target, and you assign it to the Guardian Golems. After this attack, the opponent decdies not to attack, and then you get to attack again. You then choose to use the delayed effect from Cloud of Steel for Ice Assassinating Attack 2. The opponent decides not to block, and you use the damage to push the opponent to an adjacent plains space.

Forked Composite Effects

Composite effects allow you to play another effect as part of their effect. In most cases, these effects are played as an immediate effect, so they are affected from the bonuses and penalties of their originating effect.

Cards with effects like the Advanced Action Maximal Effect were especially complicated and raised many questions. In this module, there are some forked composite effects - composite effects that allow you to play multiple other effects. All of these effects are resolved in order and as part of resolving their originating effect.

Bonuses and Penalties

When resolving a composite effect with bonuses and penalties:

1. Apply all bonuses to the first modifiable effect resolved
2. Apply as many penalties as possible to the first modifiable effect resolved. Apply the rest to the next effect resolved.
3. In case an effect is resolved with some penalties still not fully applied, take Wounds equal to the amount that was not applied.

Bonuses and penalties for an effect can never apply to its originating effect. In other words, if effect A provides you with multiple effects and one of them allows you to play effect B, bonuses and penalties for effect B cannot apply to effect A and its other subeffect.

Artifact colors

All Artifact cards are considered colorless. During your turn you can treat your own Artifact cards as any color or a combination of multiple colors. There is no longer a need to mention on each specific effect that deals with a card's colors how it handles Artifact cards.

Jormund the Dwarf of the Forgemasters

Treat Jormund as any other hero in the game. Since Jormund uses many rules that were introduced in the Rise of the Forgemasters expansion, it is recommended that you play him when you are familiar with the new rules.

Notes on Jormund's Skills

The skills **Wind of Change** and **Song of Storms** depend on which colors are scarce. When you play the skill and choose either of its two effects, check if the corresponding color is scarce. If it is, the chosen effect is doubled (it is still a single effect, so you cannot reduce the armor of two different enemies with Song of Courage. Notice that these effects have some restrictions on them (e.g. the Siege Attack from Song of Courage cannot be played in the Attack phase).

The skill **Burst of Energy** allows you to play both the basic and the stronger effect of a single Action card in the same turn. You cannot use it to play cards that are not in your play area (you cannot play cards that you threw away or cards you played from the Advanced Action offer). For example, you can use the basic effect of the Basic Action card **Swiftness** for Move 2 and move to an adjacent plains space, and later use Burst of Energy with a white crystal to play Ranged Attack 3.

The skills **Sparkling Diamonds** and **Healing Stones** allow you to either spend a crystal, or to spend something in order to gain two crystals. Notice that Sparkling Diamonds must be used as part of Interaction, and Healing Stones cannot be played during combat.

Expansion Notes

The Rise of the Forgemasters, designed by **Lior Kiperman**, is an unofficial expansion for **Mage Knight Board Game** designed by **Vlaada Chvátil**. Mage Knight Board Game is a game by **WizKids**. The expansion is still under development so it only uses prototype art that was found online.

[Space for playtesters list and special thanks]